```
var_dump(
    (new DateTime('01-SEP-2024'))->format('Y-m-d H:i:s')
);
var_dump(
    (new DateTime('3rd September 2024 05:00'))->format('Y-m-d H:i:s')
);
```

```
Output:
string(19) "2024-09-01 00:00:00"
string(19) "2024-09-03 00:05:00"
```

I hope the Deep Space 9 fans out there immediately recognize those dates, and hopefully you also noticed that if no time component is given in the string, then the default will be the very start of the day: midnight (*00:00:00*). In addition to formatted absolute dates, it is also possible to use relative words like "now" (which is the default parameter value for the `DateTime` constructor) or "today":

```
var_dump(
    (new DateTime('now'))->format('Y-m-d H:i:s')
);
var_dump(
    (new DateTime('today'))->format('Y-m-d H:i:s')
);
```

```
Output:
string(19) "2024-11-18 17:25:06"
string(19) "2024-11-18 00:00:00"
```

Note that `'now'` really does mean "right this second," while `'today'` begins at midnight on the current date. For other relative values, use "today" or "now" with a valid `DateTime::modify()` string like so:

```
var_dump(
    (new DateTime('today + 1 day'))->format('Y-m-d H:i:s')
);
var_dump(
    (new DateTime('today - 12 hours'))->format('Y-m-d H:i:s')
);
```